

How to Use This Journal

Sequential numbering. Entries are pre-numbered from 001 onward. Never skip, remove, or reorder a page — sequential numbering deters tampering and satisfies most state record-keeping requirements.

One act per entry. Record a single notarial act on each numbered page. Complete every applicable field at the time of the act, in permanent ink.

Identification. Note the signer's ID type, number, and expiration date. Capture the signer's right thumbprint in the box on the outer edge when your state requires it.

Fees. Record the fee charged, or mark it Waived, to stay within your state's fee schedule.

When full. Store completed journals securely for your state's retention period (often 7 to 10 years). Begin a new volume and update the Volume ____ of ____ line.

Index. Use the summary index at the back of this journal to locate entries quickly.

STATE-SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS

California: Thumbprint required. Journal required by law. 4-year retention.

Florida: Thumbprint optional. No journal requirement (recommended).

New York: No journal requirement. 10-year retention recommended.

Texas: No journal requirement. 5-year retention recommended.

Illinois: No journal requirement. 5-year retention recommended.

Pennsylvania: No journal requirement. 10-year retention recommended.

TYPICAL FEE SCHEDULE (US)

Acknowledgment: \$5 – \$15

Oath / Affirmation: \$5 – \$10

Jurat: \$5 – \$15

Copy Certification: \$5 – \$10

Signature Witnessing: \$5 – \$15

Proof of Execution: \$5 – \$20